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MEDIA & EVENTS

Seigler Building & Development — August 2026 Digital Advertising Summary

Reporting period: August 1 – August 31, 2026

The First Full Month on the New Site

The new website went live on July 6, so August is the first complete month of clean data it has produced. It is also the first report in a new format: from here on, inquiry numbers are drawn **directly from the website's own submission records** rather than from analytics estimates, and the report includes a Google Search section covering how the site performs in unpaid search results. The result is a smaller set of numbers than you may be used to seeing, but every one of them is something we can stand behind and trace back to a name and a date.

The Month in Numbers

- **4 genuine inquiries** from the website contact form, verified individually
- **8 phone taps** and **4 email clicks** from the site — 16 direct contact actions in total
- Website visitors: **865** across **975** sessions (up 13.5% and 11.8%)
- Pages viewed: **1,769** (up 16.7%)
- Google Ads: **11,103** impressions and **616** clicks
- Unpaid Google search clicks: **118** (up 51%), average position improved from **25.2 to 21**

The Inquiries

Four people contacted Seigler through the website in August with a real project. These are verified individually from the site's submission records — automated and vendor submissions have been removed, so this is the actual list:

- **August 6 — Marc Moreno, Tellico Village.** Wants to visit a showroom or completed home in the area and discuss plans.
- **August 11 — Lisa Niemi, Espalier Bay, Decatur.** A luxury high-end build on the Tennessee River.
- **August 19 — Ryan Eckert, Sharps Channel.** Asking about build costs based on topography and lot dimensions, before making an offer on the land.
- **August 31 — Tim Nicholas, Lenoir City.** Looking for a reputable lakefront home builder.

Four inquiries is a number that only makes sense in context. This is a business where a single project runs into seven figures and a year of work — four qualified conversations in a month is a healthy pipeline, not a thin one. What matters more than the count is what they have in common.

Every Single One Was Waterfront

All four August inquiries were lakefront or riverfront projects. Tellico Village, the Tennessee River at Espalier Bay, Sharps Channel, and Lenoir City on Tellico Lake. Not one was an inland build.

That is a striking pattern, and it becomes more striking when set against where the advertising budget actually went. Of the 11,103 ad impressions delivered in August, **the lakefront-specific ad group received 83** — under one percent. Roughly 86% of the budget's reach went to the broadest, most generic "custom home builder" phrasing.

The specialty terms were also the ones people responded to hardest. Where the generic ad group converted about 5 in every 100 people who saw it, the lakefront group converted 12 and the high-end group 21. In other words: the narrower, more expensive-sounding searches produce two to four times the response, they produced every genuine inquiry this month, and they were the ones the campaign was barely showing up for.

We have since rebuilt the account around this. Bids have been restructured to push meaningfully more budget toward the lakefront, luxury and high-end groups and away from generic traffic, and a large set of irrelevant search terms has been excluded. Those changes went live in mid-September, so they do not appear in these August figures — but they are a direct response to what August showed us.

Paid Search: More Exposure, Same Traffic

The honest read on Google Ads in August is that it bought more visibility without buying more visitors. Impressions rose 20.4% to 11,103, but clicks moved only from 610 to 616, and the click-through rate fell from 6.62% to 5.55%.

That combination — more impressions, same clicks — means the extra reach was low-quality: the campaign was appearing for more searches, but not better ones. This is the clearest possible argument for the tighter, more selective setup now in place, and it is why the September changes were made when they were. Expect the coming months to show *fewer* but better-qualified clicks. That is the intended direction, not a problem: the aim is to reach fewer browsers and more lakefront prospects.

The Unpaid Side Is Where the Growth Was

Every bit of August's growth came from channels that cost nothing per click. Paid search traffic was effectively flat (down 0.9%). Meanwhile:

- **Organic search visits rose 53%** — from 109 sessions to 167
- Direct visits (people typing the name in) rose 15%
- Visits arriving from AI assistants rose 38%
- Social referrals rose 90%

And organic visitors behave far better than paid ones. People who found the site through unpaid search stayed engaged for **1 minute 26 seconds per session** against 37 seconds for paid visitors, with a 70% engagement rate against 59%. Measured per person, organic visitors spent 1 minute 51 seconds engaged — nearly three times the paid figure. The new site is earning its own audience, and that audience reads more carefully.

Google Search Performance

The Search Console data shows why organic traffic grew:

- Clicks from unpaid Google results: **118**, up from 78 — a 51% increase
- Impressions: **8,580**, up 4.8%
- Average click-through rate: **1.4%**, up from 1.0%
- **Average position: 21, improved from 25.2**

Average position is the one to watch. Moving from 25.2 to 21 is the difference between being buried on the third page of results and sitting at the edge of the second — and the climb from there is where clicks start accelerating. The site gained 51% more clicks on only 4.8% more impressions, which is exactly what happens when rankings improve rather than when exposure merely widens.

Two things stand out in the search terms. First, **lakefront and lake-area phrases are climbing fast** — "custom homes lakes area" went from 6 impressions to 114, and "luxury custom homes in lenoir city"

appeared from nothing to 148. The unpaid side is independently confirming what the inquiries showed.

Second, and more surprising: **the single largest source of new search visibility is renovation and remodeling.** "Luxury home renovations" alone drew 429 impressions, with "luxury remodels" at 146 and "luxury home remodel" at 68 — 643 impressions across that cluster, more than any other theme on the site. There is currently no advertising at all pointed at renovation work. If high-end remodeling is something Seigler wants more of, the demand is visibly there and nobody is paying to meet it.

What People Looked At

Beyond the homepage, the Signature Projects section was the most visited area of the site (156 views), followed by the team page (121) and the gallery (94). The individual project pages held attention longest — Highlands Manor averaged a full minute per visit, Stonehaven Retreat 53 seconds and Timberline Estate 39 seconds, against 16 seconds on the homepage. People are spending their time on the finished work, which is the right thing for a builder's site to be doing.

Where This Points

August's message is unusually clear for a low-volume month. The inquiries that arrived were all waterfront, the unpaid search data is independently trending toward lake-area terms, and the advertising was pointed almost entirely somewhere else. That mismatch has now been corrected in the ad account, and the next two reports will show whether the narrower targeting produces the higher-quality traffic it is designed for.

Two opportunities sit open beyond that: the renovation and remodeling demand showing up in search results with no campaign behind it, and the Google Business Profile listing — which we're still waiting on access to add to this report, and which is typically a meaningful source of local inquiries for a builder.
